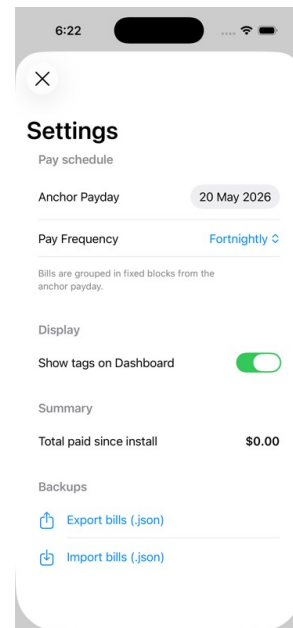
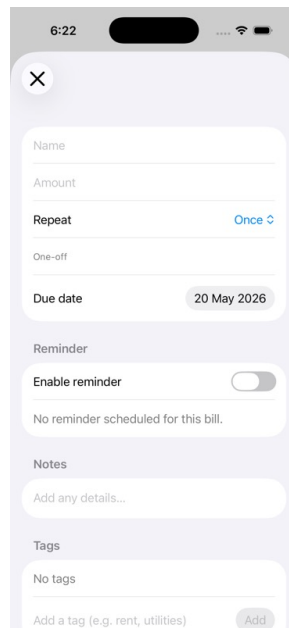
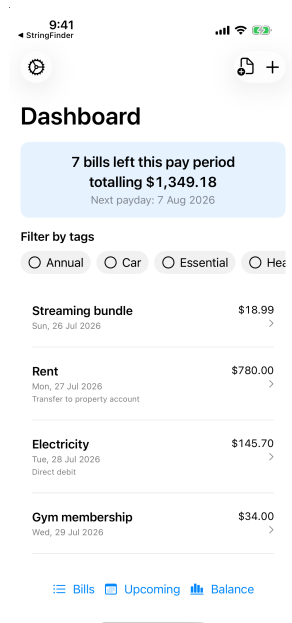


BILLTRACKER

User Guide

Everything you need to set up your pay schedule, add and manage bills, understand upcoming costs, import statement PDFs, and protect your data.

Version 1.0 | 26 July 2026



How to use this guide

This guide follows the current BillTracker interface. Button names appear in bold. Dates, totals, and screenshots are examples; the app calculates them from your bills and pay schedule.

The central idea

BillTracker groups bills by pay period, not simply by calendar month. Set the pay schedule first, because it controls the Dashboard, Upcoming list, and Balance analysis.

Contents

Section	What it covers
1	First launch and essential setup
2	Dashboard and tag filters
3	Add a bill and choose its recurrence
4	Edit, inspect, and delete bills
5	Bills, Upcoming, and Balance screens
6	Import recurring expenses from PDF statements
7	Settings reference
8	Backups, data handling, and troubleshooting

Quick reference: main controls

Control	Purpose
Gear (top left)	Open Settings.
Document with plus (top right)	Scan one or more bank statement PDFs for recurring expenses.
Plus (top right)	Add a bill manually.
Bills	View one summary row per bill series and filter by frequency.
Upcoming	View the next year of bills grouped by pay period.
Balance	Compare pay-period totals and see possible due-date moves.

1. First launch and essential setup

On the first launch, BillTracker explains that it organises bills around your payday. Tap Get started to open the Dashboard.

6:21



Set your pay schedule before adding many bills. This makes every pay-period calculation meaningful from the beginning.

Recommended first-time sequence

- 1 Tap the gear on the Dashboard.
- 2 Choose Pay Frequency.
- 3 For Weekly, Fortnightly, or Every 4 weeks, set Anchor Payday to a date you know was or will be a payday.
- 4 For Monthly (same date), set Payday each month instead.
- 5 Close Settings, then tap the plus button to add your first bill.



Track bills by pay period

BillTracker organises bills around your payday instead of calendar months, so you always know what's due before you get paid.

Get started

The onboarding page appears once.

What is an anchor payday?

It is one known payday used as the reference point for a repeating weekly, fortnightly, or four-week cycle. It does not have to be the next payday; it only has to be a correct payday in that cycle.

How the current pay period works

- The current period begins on a payday and ends immediately before the next payday.
- The Dashboard only shows occurrences due from today through the end of the current pay period. Earlier dates in the same period are treated as already paid.
- The Dashboard refreshes when bills or pay settings change, when the app becomes active, and when the calendar day changes.

2. Dashboard and tag filters



Dashboard

7 bills left this pay period
totalling \$1,349.18
Next payday: 7 Aug 2026

Filter by tags

☐ Annual ☐ Car ☐ Essential ☐ Health

Streaming bundle \$18.99
Sun, 26 Jul 2026 >

Rent \$780.00
Mon, 27 Jul 2026
Transfer to property account >

Electricity \$145.70
Tue, 28 Jul 2026
Direct debit >

Gym membership \$34.00
Wed, 29 Jul 2026 >

Bills Upcoming Balance

A populated Dashboard with fictional example bills.

If the Dashboard says 'No bills to show'

Either no bill is due between today and the next payday, or no bill matches the selected tags. Clear the tag filter, check the pay schedule, then check bill start/due dates.

The summary card

The blue card shows the number of bills left in the current pay period, their combined AUD amount, and the next payday.

Bill rows

- Rows are sorted by due date.
- Each row shows the bill name, due date, amount, and up to two lines of notes.
- Tap a row to open Bill details. There is no long-press menu.

Tag filtering

- When enabled, tags appear as selectable chips above the list.
- Select one or more tags. A bill is included if it has any selected tag.
- The summary count and total change to match the filter.
- Tap Clear to remove the filter.

Currency

Amounts are currently displayed and totalled in Australian dollars (AUD). There is no currency setting in this version.

3. Add a bill

The Add Bill form and live preview.

Tap the plus button on the Dashboard. Complete the fields, review the Preview section, then use the checkmark at the top left to save.

Basic fields

- Name: a recognisable name such as Electricity or Car Insurance.
- Amount: numbers and one decimal point are accepted; the app displays the result as AUD.
- Repeat: choose Once, Weekly, Fortnightly, Every X Weeks, Monthly, Six monthly, or Yearly.
- Due date: used for a one-off bill.
- Start date: the first/seed date for a recurring bill.
- Has end date: optionally stop a recurring bill after an inclusive final date.

Save and cancel controls

Before you make changes, the top-left X closes the form. Once the form changes, it becomes a two-part control: the curved back arrow cancels (after confirmation), and the checkmark saves.

Use the Preview

Before saving, confirm Next due, Repeats, Amount, and Reminder. This is the quickest way to catch a wrong start date or repeat rule.

3.1 Recurrence options

A recurrence is anchored to the bill's start date. For short months, day-of-month schedules are clamped to the last valid day.

Repeat option	Additional control	Meaning
Once	Due date	A single occurrence. No end date is shown.
Weekly	Every 1 week	Repeats every seven days from the start date.
Fortnightly	Every 2 weeks	Repeats every fourteen days from the start date.
Every X Weeks	1 to 12 weeks	Choose a custom week interval. Selecting 1 or 2 changes the named option to Weekly or Fortnightly.
Monthly - Day of month	First day, Last day, or 1 to 31	Repeats on the selected calendar day. Last day (stored as day 31) adapts to shorter months.
Monthly - Weekday	1st, 2nd, 3rd, 4th, or Last + weekday	For example, the last Friday of every month.
Six monthly	Start date	Repeats every six months.
Yearly	Start date	Repeats on the same month and day each year; leap dates are clamped when necessary.

End dates

- An end date is inclusive: an occurrence on that date is included.
- The end date cannot be earlier than the start date.
- Tap Clear end date to return the schedule to open-ended.

Notes and tags

- Notes can hold account details, payment method, reference numbers, or any reminder text. Avoid storing passwords or full card details.
- Tags are optional labels such as rent, utilities, subscriptions, or annual. Tag names are matched without regard to upper/lower case.
- As you type a tag, BillTracker suggests existing tags. Tap a suggestion or tap Add.
- If Show tags on Dashboard is off, the Tags section is hidden in the add/edit form as well as on the Dashboard.

3.2 Reminders

Each recurring bill has an Enable reminder toggle and a lead-time stepper from 0 to 365 days. The preview shows the selected lead time.

- 1 Open a new or existing recurring bill.
- 2 Turn on Enable reminder.
- 3 Choose how many days before the due date the reminder should fire.
- 4 Save the bill and allow notifications if iOS asks.

Current reminder limitation

The current app has per-bill reminder controls, but the underlying global reminder enable switch and reminder time are not exposed in Settings. As a result, reminders may not actually be scheduled in this build. One-off bills are also explicitly excluded from notification scheduling. Treat reminder fields as preparatory until a global Reminders setting is added and verified.

If reminders are later enabled globally

- The default notification time in the current implementation is 9:00 am local time.
- A reminder is only scheduled for the next future occurrence and must itself be in the future.
- Deleting a bill or turning off its reminder removes its pending notification.
- If notification permission is denied, it must be changed in the iPhone Settings app.

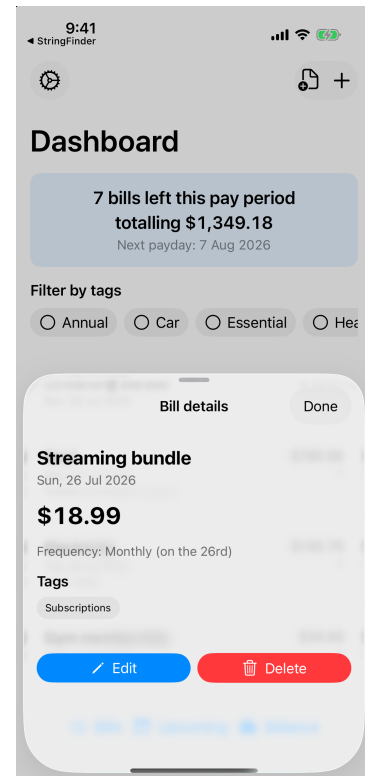
What is not a setting

There is currently no visible global Reminders section, no reminder-time picker, no currency picker, no theme selector, and no reset-onboarding control. These should not be expected on the Settings page in version 1.0.

4. Inspect, edit, and delete bills

Tap a bill occurrence on the Dashboard or Upcoming screen. The Bill details sheet shows its name, selected occurrence date, amount, frequency, tags, and notes.

Use Edit to change it, Delete to remove the displayed stored version, or Done to close the sheet.



Bill details for a fictional example bill.

Editing a recurring bill

Future-only behavior

Changes to a recurring bill are applied from a cut-off date forward, preserving the earlier history. From Upcoming, the cut-off is the occurrence you tapped. From the Dashboard or Bills list, it is normally the next due occurrence.

- Changing name, amount, notes, tags, reminder, or end date creates a future version of the same bill series when needed.
- Changing the recurrence applies the new rule to the bill series from the cut-off onward, including later future versions.
- Changing a bill to Once overwrites it as a one-off bill rather than splitting it.
- The start date remains the recurrence anchor for future-only edits; the effective-from date controls when the new version begins.

Deleting

Delete removes the specific stored bill version shown in the detail sheet after a confirmation. The warning says the action cannot be undone. Export a JSON backup first if the data matters.

Important delete nuance

A recurring bill that has been split by past edits can consist of multiple stored versions. Deleting one version does not necessarily delete every version in that series.

5. Bills, Upcoming, and Balance

All Bills

- Shows one summary row per linked bill series.
- Each row shows name, current amount, frequency, most recent occurrence before today ('Last paid'), and next occurrence on or after today ('Next due').
- There is no manual paid/unpaid checkbox. A scheduled occurrence before today is treated as past/paid for this summary and for 'Total paid since install'.
- Use the Frequency menu to show All, Once, Weekly, Fortnightly, Monthly, Yearly, or Custom bills.
- Tap a row to edit its current or next applicable version.

Upcoming Bills

- Looks forward one year from today.
- Groups occurrences into the pay periods defined in Settings.
- Each section header shows an inclusive date range and the section total.
- Tap a row for details. Editing begins from the exact future occurrence tapped.

Pay Period Balance

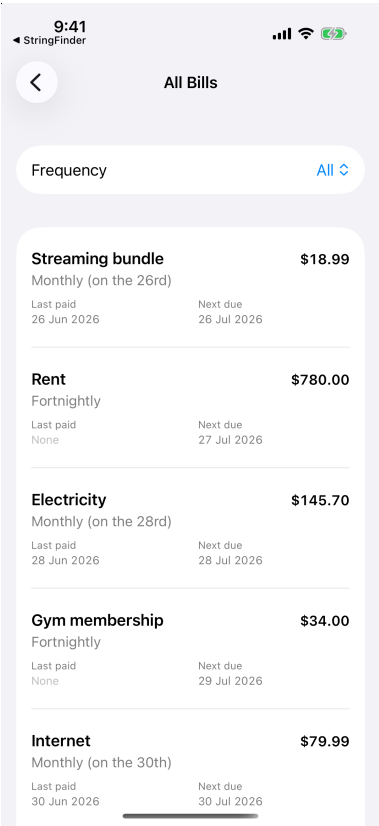
Element	How to read it
Periods: 8 / 12 / 26	Select how many future pay periods the analysis includes.
Spread	The highest visible period total minus the lowest visible period total.
Average	The mean total across the visible periods.
Bill total chart	Blue bars compare total commitments by pay period; the dotted line is the average.
Difference chart	Orange means the period is higher than the previous one; green means lower.
Suggestions	Possible one-bill due-date moves that would reduce the spread. These are advisory only; they do not change a bill.
Periods list	Exact total and change from the preceding period.

Using a suggestion

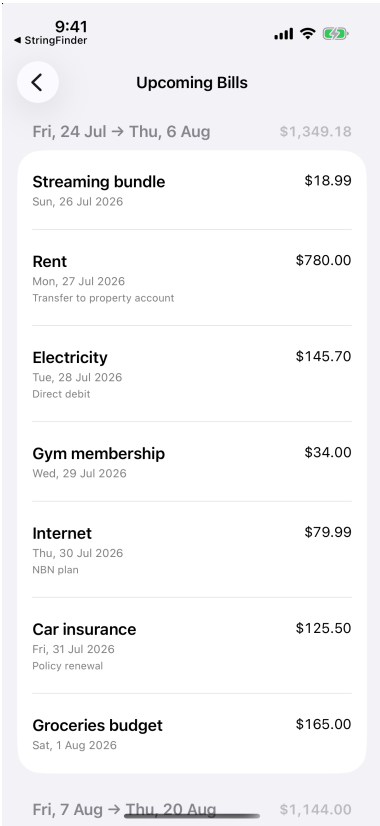
Open the bill from Bills or Upcoming and adjust its due date only if the service provider allows it. The Balance screen does not automatically edit or contact the provider.

5.1 Feature screens

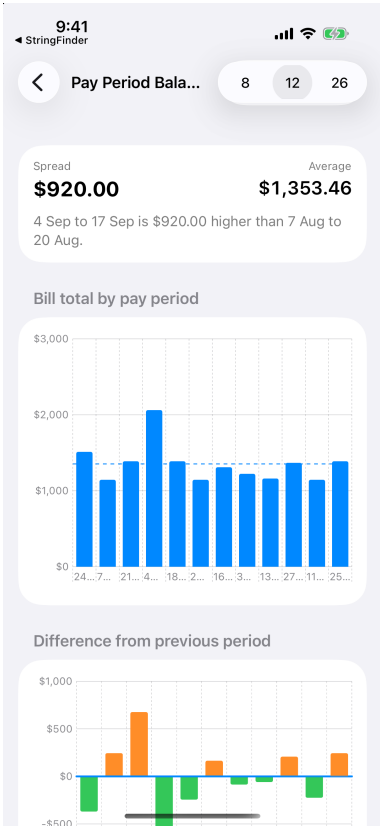
These examples use fictional bills. They show how the three Dashboard destinations present the same schedules in different ways.



All Bills: one row per bill series.



Upcoming: occurrences grouped by pay period.

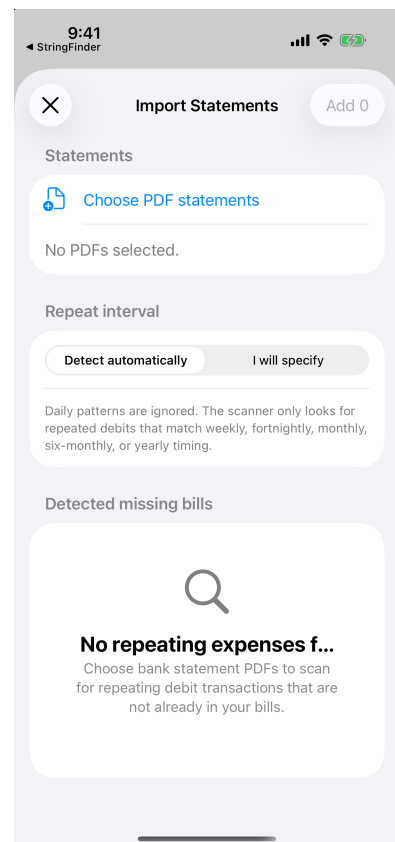


Balance: totals, spread, and differences.

6. Import recurring expenses from PDF statements

Tap the document with plus icon on the Dashboard. This tool reads text from one or more bank statement PDFs, finds repeated debit transactions, and offers missing bills to add.

- 1 Tap Choose PDF statements and select one or more PDFs.
- 2 Choose Detect automatically, or choose I will specify and select Weekly, Fortnightly, Monthly, Six monthly, or Yearly.
- 3 Wait for scanning to finish, then review each candidate's name, amount, recurrence, matched date range, and recent transactions.
- 4 Check or uncheck candidates. Candidates with no possible existing match are selected automatically.
- 5 Review every orange Possible existing bill warning to avoid duplicates.
- 6 Tap Add N. Imported bills receive an 'imported' tag and a note recording that they came from statement import.



The statement importer before PDFs are selected.

What the detector does

- Requires at least two transactions for a merchant pattern.
- Ignores daily patterns and gaps of three days or less.
- Looks for weekly, fortnightly, monthly, six-monthly, or yearly timing with interval tolerances.
- Uses the most recent matching amount as the candidate amount.
- Compares candidate name, amount, and recurrence with existing bills and displays up to three possible matches.

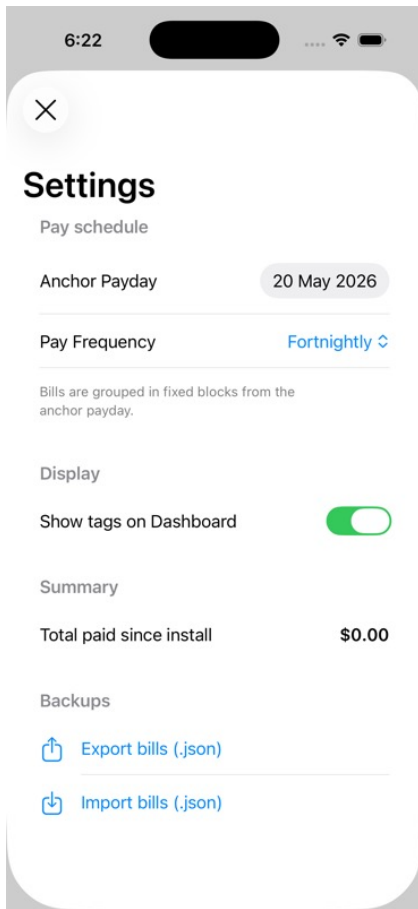
PDF compatibility

The statement must contain selectable text. Scanned or image-only PDFs are not supported because the current importer does not perform OCR. Statements with unusual layouts may also need manual checking.

Privacy

Statement parsing happens on the device in the current implementation. The app extracts debit date, description, and amount for detection. Still, bank statements are sensitive: only select files you trust and close the importer after use.

7. Settings reference



The complete visible Settings screen for a fixed pay cycle.

Open Settings with the gear icon. Changes apply immediately; there is no separate Save button. Tap X to close.

Pay schedule

- Anchor Payday: active for Weekly, Fortnightly, and Every 4 weeks. Choose any known payday in the cycle.
- Pay Frequency: Weekly, Fortnightly, Every 4 weeks, or Monthly (same date).
- Payday each month: appears only for Monthly (same date), range 1 to 31.

Display

Show tags on Dashboard controls dashboard tag filters and also whether the Tags section appears while adding or editing a bill.

Summary

Total paid since install is the calculated total of scheduled occurrences before today. It is not based on manual payment confirmations.

Backups

Export or import the complete bill list as JSON. Pay schedule and display preferences are not included in that JSON bill archive.

Monthly day 29, 30, or 31

When a month is shorter, the monthly payday boundary is clamped to that month's last valid day. For example, day 31 becomes 30 in April and 28 or 29 in February.

7.1 Pay schedule examples

Your pay arrangement	Choose	Set
Every Friday	Weekly	Anchor Payday = a Friday that is a real payday.
Every second Thursday	Fortnightly	Anchor Payday = one real Thursday payday, not an off-week Thursday.
Every 28 days	Every 4 weeks	Anchor Payday = one real payday in the 28-day cycle.
The 15th of each month	Monthly (same date)	Payday each month = 15. Anchor Payday is disabled.
Last day of each month	Monthly (same date)	Payday each month = 31, which clamps to the last valid day.

Fixed cycles versus monthly

- Weekly, Fortnightly, and Every 4 weeks use fixed 7-, 14-, or 28-day blocks counted from the anchor.
- Monthly (same date) uses calendar-month boundaries. The anchor field is disabled and recalculated automatically from the selected monthly day.
- Changing the pay schedule does not alter any bill's own due date or recurrence; it changes how bills are grouped and analysed.

Check after changing the schedule

- 1 Close Settings and confirm that the Dashboard's next payday is correct.
- 2 Open Upcoming and check the first few pay-period date ranges.
- 3 Open Balance and confirm the grouping matches how you budget.

If every total suddenly looks wrong

The usual cause is an incorrect anchor date or pay frequency. Choose one real payday from the correct cycle, then recheck Upcoming before editing any bills.

8. Back up and restore

Export

- 1 Open Settings and tap Export bills (.json).
- 2 Wait for the share sheet, then save the file to Files, iCloud Drive, AirDrop, or another trusted location.
- 3 Keep the file private; it can contain bill names, amounts, dates, notes, and tags.

Import

- 1 Open Settings and tap Import bills (.json).
- 2 Choose a BillTracker JSON export or a compatible plain bill array.
- 3 Choose one of the strategies below.

Import strategy	Use when	Effect
Replace all (overwrite)	Restoring a complete backup as the only source of truth.	Deletes/replaces the current in-app list with the imported list. This is destructive.
Merge by ID	Re-importing a backup derived from the same BillTracker data.	Updates bills with matching internal IDs and adds unknown IDs.
Merge by Name + Start Date + Recurrence	Combining independently created or older lists where IDs may differ.	Treats matching name, start day, and repeat rule as the same schedule; preserves the existing ID/series and overwrites other bill fields.

Safest restore habit

Export the current list first. Then use Replace all only when you are certain the chosen backup should become the complete bill list. For uncertain files, prefer a merge and inspect Bills for duplicates.

What a bill backup contains

The JSON archive contains its format version, export time, and every stored bill version, including internal IDs, series links, names, amounts, dates, recurrence rules, notes, tags, and per-bill reminder fields. It does not include pay schedule, display preferences, onboarding state, notification permission, or the cached total-paid value.

8.1 Data handling and maintenance

Where data lives

- Bills are stored as JSON in the app's Application Support/BillTracker directory with atomic writes and complete file protection.
- Older installations that stored bills in UserDefaults are migrated automatically when bills load.
- Pay schedule and interface preferences are stored separately as app preferences.
- BillTracker's date calculations use the Sydney calendar/time zone helpers in the current build.

Useful maintenance routine

- 1 Once a month, review All Bills for outdated amounts and expired services.
- 2 Before a major edit or import, export a dated JSON backup.
- 3 After changing payday arrangements, verify Upcoming and Balance.
- 4 Review imported statement candidates carefully and remove duplicates promptly.

Current limitations to remember

- No manual paid/unpaid status: past scheduled occurrences are assumed paid.
- No undo after delete or Replace all import.
- No automatic cloud sync is described or implemented in the current source.
- No OCR for scanned/image-only bank statements.
- No currency choice; visible amounts use AUD.
- Reminder fields exist, but the global reminder controls are not currently exposed in Settings.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to check
Wrong next payday or pay-period ranges	Open Settings. Confirm Pay Frequency and a genuine Anchor Payday, or the correct monthly day.
A bill is missing from the Dashboard	It may be before today, after the next payday, ended, or hidden by tag filters. Check Upcoming and clear tags.
A recurrence falls on an unexpected day	Check the bill's start date and repeat controls. Day 31 and leap dates clamp in shorter months.
Duplicate bills after statement import	Review orange possible-match warnings before import. Afterwards, inspect Bills and delete the unwanted record/version.
Statement cannot be read	Confirm the PDF has selectable text. Image-only scans are unsupported. Try a statement exported directly from the bank.
No recurring candidates found	Select statements spanning enough time for at least two matching debits. Try specifying the expected interval.
Reminder does not appear	This build lacks the visible global enable/time setting. Also check iOS notification permission and ensure the reminder date is still in the future.
Total paid seems too high or low	It is generated from scheduled past occurrences, not confirmations. Check start dates, end dates, amounts, and duplicate bill versions.
Import created unexpected changes	Restore a prior export with Replace all, if available. There is no in-app undo.

Keeping the guide current

This guide describes BillTracker version 1.0. When the app gains or changes features, update the bundled guide so the instructions continue to match the interface.

End of guide